Modi on LinkedIn: Differentiated Communication Strategies

The big difference between the BJP and the Congress is that while the latter, until 2019, concentrated on Twitter, the BJP had 360-degree coverage on digital platforms: the prime minister has a LinkedIn account, his team maintains a Pinterest board and his YouTube channel in November 2019 had posted some 12,124 videos and had 4.26 million followers (compared to Rahul's 713 videos with 186,000 followers).[38]

Modi opened a LinkedIn account at the height of the Lok Sabha election campaign in 2014.[39] His first post, 'ICT for One Nation-One Mission', was typical of his messaging to aspirational middle-class Indian voters.[40]

> I believe in the Mantra of 'IT+IT=IT' (Information Technology + Indian Talent = India Tomorrow). … We need to work to create an atmosphere whereby India becomes the home of the next Apple, Google, Facebook, Twitter and Amazon! … With a policy driven and result oriented approach, I see no reason why India cannot become the next hub of cloud infrastructure … We have heard of e-governance but now is the time to move towards m-governance (Mobile governance) … The role of the Internet is paramount now. We need to think of a future where every home and office has internet and High Speed Data access becomes a basic utility, much like electricity, water and telephones. Handheld devices like mobile phones, tablets etc. need to be better deployed to fulfill the aspirations of the masses. We need to be a lot faster on taking the Internet to every doorstep and this calls for a time-bound programme to expand internet and broadband connectivity both in urban and rural areas.

The prime minister's LinkedIn account, which had gathered over 3 million followers by November 2019, perfectly exemplifies his approach to digital outreach: message discipline combined with maximum outreach.

While the Congress was over-focused on one platform, the BJP's approach of saturation coverage across all platforms was in